

August 20, 2026

TRICARE East (Humana Military)
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Marlin Kuphal (MRN MUSC4410722), Claim MUSC-3CE3-3

Patient	Marlin Kuphal (DOB 1941-08-11)
MRN	MUSC4410722
Member ID / Group	TRI659593889 / GRP-81211
Claim number	MUSC-3CE3-3
Date of service	2026-06-13
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$1,082.64
Denial code	CARC 27 / RARC N30 — Expenses incurred after coverage terminated.
Appeal deadline	2026-10-21

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Marlin Kuphal (MRN: MUSC4410722, Member ID: TRI659593889) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-3CE3-3 for services rendered on June 13, 2026, at MUSC Health University Medical Center, Charleston, SC. The claim was denied on July 23, 2026, under CARC 27 ("Expenses incurred after coverage terminated") and RARC N30 ("Patient ineligible for this service"), with the payer remark stating: "Member was not eligible for benefits on the date of service billed." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination. The patient's TRICARE East (Humana Military) Advantage coverage is documented as active from January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026, which encompasses the June 13, 2026, date of service. The denial therefore appears to reflect an administrative eligibility discrepancy rather than an actual lapse in coverage.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Marlin Kuphal is an 85-year-old male with an established history of care, presenting on June 13, 2026, to an on-campus outpatient hospital setting (Place of Service 22) under the care of rendering provider Marcus T. Bledsoe, DO (NPI 1770615243). The visit was billed as CPT 99214, an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity, with two units submitted under revenue code 0510. The primary diagnosis was J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified), consistent with Mr. Kuphal's longstanding history of recurrent upper respiratory conditions including chronic sinusitis with onset dating to 1977. A secondary diagnosis of I10 (Essential hypertension) was also documented, reflecting a condition active since 1959 and currently managed with Hydrochlorothiazide 25 mg. The complexity of managing an acute respiratory presentation in the context of longstanding chronic sinusitis and hypertension in an 85-year-old patient is consistent with the moderate complexity level assigned to this encounter.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is that Mr. Kuphal was not eligible for benefits on the date of service. However, the coverage record on file with MUSC Health clearly reflects an active TRICARE East (Humana Military) Advantage plan under Group GRP-81211, with a coverage period of January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026. The date of service, June 13, 2026, falls squarely within this verified coverage window. MUSC Health confirmed eligibility through standard verification processes prior to rendering services, and no notification of termination or interruption of coverage was received before or at the time of the encounter. A denial under CARC 27 is appropriate only when coverage has genuinely lapsed; where active coverage exists spanning the date of service, the denial is inconsistent with the facts of record. TRICARE beneficiaries retain appeal rights under applicable federal regulations governing military health benefits, and payers are obligated to adjudicate claims in accordance with verified eligibility data. MUSC Health respectfully requests that TRICARE East conduct a thorough review of Mr. Kuphal's eligibility records for June 13, 2026, and reconcile any discrepancy between its internal system and the coverage documentation on file.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health requests that TRICARE East (Humana Military) reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-3CE3-3 and reprocess the claim for payment in accordance with the contracted allowed amount of \$807.84. Should the payer's eligibility system reflect a termination date that conflicts with the coverage period documented in this appeal, MUSC Health requests that the payer identify the specific source of that discrepancy and provide written clarification so that it may be resolved promptly. If additional documentation of Mr. Kuphal's enrollment status is required, MUSC Health will cooperate fully in obtaining and submitting that information. This appeal is being submitted within the 90-day appeal filing window, prior to the October 21, 2026, deadline.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC
Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management

MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record